

Cybersecurity Project: Mind Games and Cyber Defense

Project Title: The Human Firewall Audit

Project Description:

This project challenges students to ethically simulate a multi-vector social engineering attempt against a fictional organization and then design a defense strategy to counter it. The goal is to understand how attackers exploit human behavior and how organizations can build resilience through awareness and controls.

What is This Project About?

Purpose & Learning Outcomes:

- Apply OSINT and psychological manipulation principles to design realistic SE scenarios
- Understand how phishing, impersonation, and physical intrusion tactics work in combination
- Develop awareness training and behavioral detection strategies to counter human-centric threats

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What You Have to Do (Step-by-Step):

1. Choose a fictional target organization

- Example: "FinSecure Pvt Ltd – a mid-sized fintech company with 50 employees."

2. Conduct OSINT-based recon

- Use public sources (LinkedIn, GitHub, job boards) to simulate how an attacker would gather info about roles, tech stack, and employee behavior.

3. Design a multi-vector attack scenario

- Combine at least two SE vectors (e.g., phishing + impersonation, or vishing + USB drop). Describe the attacker's goal, pretext, and execution plan.

4. Create awareness materials

- Design a poster or training slide that educates employees about the specific attack vectors used in your scenario.

5. Build a defense strategy summary

- Include behavioral red flags, technical controls (e.g., MFA, email filters), and awareness campaign ideas tailored to the fictional company

What to Submit:**Students must submit following to be eligible for certification**

All in a PDF or a DOC with screenshots and precise points making a report.

- **Attack Scenario Write-Up**
 - Target profile
 - Recon findings
 - Attack vectors and execution plan
- **Awareness Tactics:**
 - Visual + message + call to action
- **Red Flag Checklist**
 - List of behavioral and technical indicators
- **Defense Strategy Summary**
 - Awareness plan + technical controls + detection ideas

Tips for Students:

- Keep it ethical: Use only public data and fictional targets. No real phishing or impersonation. Because we don't support impersonation and malicious intents.
- Be creative but realistic: Think like an attacker, but defend like a strategist.
- Use visuals: Posters and slides should be clear, engaging, and informative.
- Reference real breaches: Tie your scenario to known SE incidents for credibility.
- Think like and IT Support Team: Your defense strategy should be practical and role-aware.

Deadline:

Submit your project by 18th Oct 2025, 11:59pm in PDF or DOC format and the submission link will be provided by the team to you. So, make sure to be active and keep checking the community for the same.

Thanks and Happy Learning Everyone!!